

UPSC INDIAN POLITY

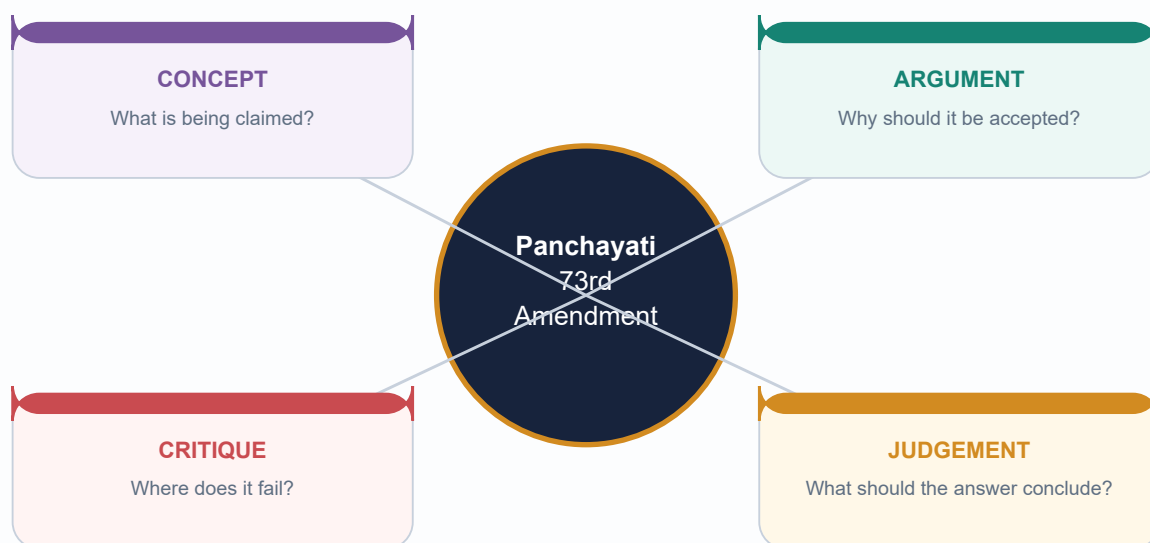
Panchayati Raj — 73rd Amendment (Articles 243–243-O, Part IX) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE Deep-Learning Visual Notes

Indian Polity · GS Paper II · Prelims + Mains

Layer 1: Basic foundation · Layer 2: Advanced constitutional and exam depth

Sources: Panchayati-Raj.md + 23_Panchayati-Raj.md

Learning cards: 18



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Foundation · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

greater than **Subject:** Polity · **Tier:** Basic (foundation) · **GS-II***Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

STATIC THEORY

• greater than □ = from book · □ = mnemonic · □ = current link. *Deep dive → advanced/23_Panchayati-Raj.md.*

MEMORY HOOK

greater than □ = from book · □ = mnemonic · □ = current link. *Deep dive → advanced/23_Panchayati-Raj.md.*

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. greater than = from book · □ = mnemonic · □ = current link. *Deep dive → advanced/23_Panchayati-Raj.md.*

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Panchayati Raj — 73rd Amendment (Articles 243–243-O, Part IX) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Foundation · Snapshot

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Item	Fact
Part / Articles	Part IX, Art 243–243-O
Schedule	Eleventh Schedule — 29 subjects (Art 243-G)
Enacted / in force	73rd Amendment 1992 → in force 24 April 1993
DPSP root	Art 40 (organise village panchayats)
Founding idea	Balwant Rai Mehta Committee (1957); constitutional status → L.M. Singhvi (1986)

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Panchayati Raj — 73rd Amendment (Articles 243–243-O, Part IX) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Snapshot

HIGH

Foundation • Core idea

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

The 73rd Amendment gave **constitutional status** to **Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs)** — a **3-tier** (village–intermediate–district) system of local self-government, with mandatory elections, reservations, and a 5-year term, so panchayats no longer depend on the state government's will.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE IDEA: RECALL MAP

Core idea

Dimension 1 The 73rd Amendment gave constitutional status to Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs) — a 3-tier (village–intermediate–district) system of local self-go	Dimension 2 greater than □ Mnemonic "GET-RD-FE" — Gram Sabha · Elections (direct seats at all 3 tiers) · Three-tier ·
Dimension 3 greater than Reservation (SC/ST + 1/3 women) · Duration 5 yrs · Finance Commission (SFC) · Election	Dimension 4 greater than Commission (SEC).

STATIC THEORY

- greater than □ **Mnemonic "GET-RD-FE"** — **G**ram Sabha · **E**lections (direct seats at all 3 tiers) · **T**hree-tier ·
- greater than **R**eservation (SC/ST + 1/3 women) · **D**uration 5 yrs · **F**inance Commission (SFC) · **E**lection
- greater than Commission (SEC).

MEMORY HOOK

greater than Mnemonic "GET-RD-FE" — Gram Sabha · Elections (direct seats at all 3 tiers) · Three-tier ·

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Panchayati Raj — 73rd Amendment (Articles 243–243-O, Part IX) — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → Core idea

HIGH

Foundation • Must-Know Facts • Part 1

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

- **3-tier** system; a state **less than 20 lakh** population may skip the **intermediate** level.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS: RECALL MAP

Must-Know Facts

Dimension 1 ☐ 3-tier system; a state less than 20 lakh population may skip the intermediate level.	Dimension 2 ☐ All territorial seats at all three levels are directly elected; chairpersons at
Dimension 3 intermediate/district levels are elected indirectly, the village-chair method is left to state law, and legislatures may provide representation for MP	Dimension 4 ☐ Reservation: SC/ST by population + not less than 1/3 seats for women (many states now 50%).

STATIC THEORY

- ☐ **All territorial seats** at all three levels are directly elected; chairpersons at
- intermediate/district levels are elected indirectly, the village-chair method is left to state law, and legislatures may provide representation for MPs/MLAs and others under Art 243-C.
- ☐ Reservation: SC/ST by population + **not less than 1/3 seats for women** (many states now **50%**).
- ☐ **5-year term**; re-election within **6 months** of dissolution.
- ☐ Candidate minimum age = **21** (not 25).
- ☐ **State Election Commission** conducts polls; **State Finance Commission** every 5 years.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. **3-tier system**; a state **less than 20 lakh** population may skip the **intermediate** level.
2. **All territorial seats** at all three levels are directly elected; chairpersons at
3. Reservation: SC/ST by population + **not less than 1/3 seats for women** (many states now **50%**).
4. **5-year term**; re-election within **6 months** of dissolution.
5. Candidate minimum age = **21** (not 25).
6. **State Election Commission** conducts polls; **State Finance Commission** every 5 years.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Panchayati Raj — 73rd Amendment (Articles 243–243-O, Part IX) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Must-Know Facts

HIGH

Foundation • Must-Know Facts • Part 2

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Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

- ☐ **PESA Act 1996** extends Part IX to **Fifth Schedule (tribal)** areas.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- ☐ Not applicable to **Nagaland, Meghalaya, Mizoram** & scheduled/tribal areas.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. **PESA Act 1996** extends Part IX to **Fifth Schedule (tribal) areas**.
2. Not applicable to **Nagaland, Meghalaya, Mizoram & scheduled/tribal areas**.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Panchayati Raj — 73rd Amendment (Articles 243–243-O, Part IX) — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → **Must-Know Facts**

HIGH**Foundation • ☐ Current link****GS-II** Indian Polity**NEWS TRIGGER**

☐ ☐ ☐ Many states have raised **women's reservation in PRIs to 50%**; **16th Finance Commission** grants to local bodies keep the fiscal-devolution ("3 Fs") debate alive.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of ☐ **Current link**.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Panchayati Raj — 73rd Amendment (Articles 243–243-O, Part IX) — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → ☐ **Current link**

HIGH**Advanced • Core Foundation****GS-II** Indian Polity**INTRO & ORIGIN**

greater than **Subject:** Polity · **Tier:** Advanced (exam depth) · **GS Paper:** GS-II

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE FOUNDATION: RECALL MAP**Core Foundation****Dimension 1**

greater than Subject: Polity · Tier: Advanced (exam depth) · GS Paper: GS-II

Dimension 2

greater than Grounded in: Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 38 (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF).

Dimension 3

greater than ☐ = from source book · ☐ ☐ = inference / case law · ☐ = current affairs.

Dimension 4

greater than Companion: basic/Panchayati-Raj.md.

STATIC THEORY

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- greater than □ = from source book · □□ = inference / case law · □ = current affairs.
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MUST-KNOW FACTS

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MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Panchayati Raj — 73rd Amendment (Articles 243–243-O, Part IX) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH**Advanced · PART A — EVOLUTION □**

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Balwant Rai Mehta Committee (1957)**: recommended "**democratic decentralisation**" → the **3-tier Panchayati Raj** (Gram Panchayat–Panchayat Samiti–Zila Parishad). **Rajasthan** first to launch PR (**2 Oct 1959, Nagaur**), followed by Andhra Pradesh. □□ Later committees: **Ashok Mehta (1977)** — 2-tier + political parties; **G.V.K. Rao (1985)**; **L.M. Singhvi (1986)** — **constitutional status** for PRIs (the key idea behind the 73rd Amendment).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. **Balwant Rai Mehta Committee (1957)**: recommended "**democratic decentralisation**" → the **3-tier Panchayati Raj** (Gram Panchayat–Panchayat Samiti–Zila Parishad). **Rajasthan** first to launch PR (**2 Oct 1959, Nagaur**), followed by Andhra Pradesh. □□ Later committees: **Ashok Mehta (1977)** — 2-tier + political parties; **G.V.K. Rao (1985)**; **L.M. Singhvi (1986)** — **constitutional status** for PRIs (the key idea behind the 73rd Amendment).

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Panchayati Raj — 73rd Amendment (Articles 243–243-O, Part IX) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART A — EVOLUTION □

HIGH**Advanced · PART B — 73rd AMENDMENT ACT, 1992 □**

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Added **Part IX ("The Panchayats", Art 243–243-O)** + the **Eleventh Schedule (29 functional items, Art 243-G)**. Gave **constitutional status** to PRIs, giving practical shape to **Art 40 (DPSP)**. Came into force **24 April 1993**. Provisions are **compulsory (mandatory)** or **voluntary (optional for states)**.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Added **Part IX ("The Panchayats", Art 243–243-O)** + the **Eleventh Schedule (29 functional items, Art 243-G)**. Gave **constitutional status** to PRIs, giving practical shape to **Art 40 (DPSP)**. Came into force **24 April 1993**. Provisions are **compulsory (mandatory)** or **voluntary (optional for states)**.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Panchayati Raj — 73rd Amendment (Articles 243–243-O, Part IX) — **ADVANCED** / **COMPLETE** → PART B — 73rd AMENDMENT ACT, 1992 □

HIGH**Advanced · Salient features (compulsory)**

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Feature	Detail
□ Gram Sabha	Village assembly of all registered voters — foundation of PR
□ 3-tier system	Village, intermediate, district — but a state less than 20 lakh population may skip the intermediate tier
□ Election	All territorial seats at all 3 levels directly elected; chairpersons of intermediate & district levels indirectly ; village chairperson as state law decides; Art 243-C permits specified representation
□ Reservation	SC/ST in proportion to population; ≥ 1/3 seats for women (incl. SC/ST women) at all levels + chairperson offices
□ Duration	5-year term ; elections before expiry OR within 6 months of dissolution; a reconstituted panchayat serves only the remainder
□ Disqualification	Age 21 allowed (not the 25 of state legislature)
□ State Election Commission	Governor-appointed SEC conducts panchayat elections; removed only like an HC judge
□ State Finance Commission	Governor constitutes an SFC every 5 years to review PRI finances

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Panchayati Raj — 73rd Amendment (Articles 243–243-O, Part IX) — **ADVANCED** / **COMPLETE** → Salient features (compulsory)

HIGH

Advanced · Voluntary provisions □□

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INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Endowing panchayats to function as institutions of **self-government**; devolving the **29 Eleventh-Schedule subjects**; giving reservation to **backward classes**; giving financial powers, etc.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Endowing panchayats to function as institutions of **self-government**; devolving the **29 Eleventh-Schedule subjects**; giving reservation to **backward classes**; giving financial powers, etc.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Panchayati Raj — 73rd Amendment (Articles 243–243-O, Part IX) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Voluntary provisions □□

HIGH

Advanced · Exemptions □

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Part IX does **NOT** apply to **Nagaland, Meghalaya, Mizoram**, the **Fifth/Sixth Schedule areas**, the hill areas of Manipur (district councils), and Darjeeling (Gorkha Hill Council).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Part IX does **NOT** apply to **Nagaland, Meghalaya, Mizoram**, the **Fifth/Sixth Schedule areas**, the hill areas of Manipur (district councils), and Darjeeling (Gorkha Hill Council).

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Panchayati Raj — 73rd Amendment (Articles 243–243-O, Part IX) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Exemptions □

HIGH

Advanced · PART C — PESA ACT, 1996 □

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INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Provisions of the Panchayats (Extension to the Scheduled Areas) Act, 1996** — extends Part IX to the **Fifth Schedule areas**. Empowers the **Gram Sabha** with control over local resources, minor forest produce, land alienation, and consultation before land acquisition/mining — the cornerstone of **tribal self-governance**.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Provisions of the Panchayats (Extension to the Scheduled Areas) Act, 1996 — extends Part IX to the **Fifth Schedule areas**. Empowers the **Gram Sabha** with control over local resources, minor forest produce, land alienation, and consultation before land acquisition/mining — the cornerstone of **tribal self-governance**.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Panchayati Raj — 73rd Amendment (Articles 243–243-O, Part IX) — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → **PART C** — PESA ACT, 1996

HIGH**Advanced • □ Social Audit (high-yield gap)****GS-II** Indian
Polity**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Feature	Social audit significance
Forum	Gram Sabha / community platform
Evidence	Muster rolls, bills, vouchers, measurement books, beneficiary records
Outcome	Transparency, recovery/correction, accountability of implementing agencies

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Panchayati Raj — 73rd Amendment (Articles 243–243-O, Part IX) — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → □ **Social Audit (high-yield gap)**

HIGH**Advanced • □ Social Audit (high-yield gap)****GS-II** Indian
Polity**INTRO & ORIGIN**

greater than □ Grounded in M. Laxmikant *Indian Polity* + □□ standard + □ verified. Added to close a UPSC gap.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

□ **SOCIAL AUDIT (HIGH-YIELD GAP): RECALL MAP**□ **Social Audit (high-yield gap)**

Dimension 1 greater than □ Grounded in M. Laxmikant <i>Indian Polity</i> + □□ standard + □ verified. Added to close a UPSC gap.	Dimension 2 □ Laxmikant frames Gram Sabha as the participatory-democracy core of Panchayati Raj.
Dimension 3 □ Sec 17 of MGNREGA mandates Gram Sabha monitoring and regular social audits of works within the Gram Panchayat.	Dimension 4 □□ Social audit means community verification of records, expenditure and outcomes — not merely departmental inspection.

STATIC THEORY

- ☐ Laxmikant frames Gram Sabha as the participatory-democracy core of Panchayati Raj.
- ☐ Sec 17 of MGNREGA mandates Gram Sabha monitoring and regular social audits of works within the Gram Panchayat.
- ☐ Social audit means community verification of records, expenditure and outcomes — not merely departmental inspection.
- ☐ Meghalaya enacted the Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017, widely cited as the first state social-audit law.
- greater than ☐ Trap: Social audit is participatory accountability by beneficiaries/citizens; it is not the CAG audit of accounts.

MEMORY HOOK

greater than Trap: Social audit is participatory accountability by beneficiaries/citizens; it is not the CAG audit of accounts.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. greater than Grounded in M. Laxmikant *Indian Polity* + ☐ standard + ☐ verified. Added to close a UPSC gap.
2. Laxmikant frames Gram Sabha as the participatory-democracy core of Panchayati Raj.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Panchayati Raj — 73rd Amendment (Articles 243–243-O, Part IX) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → ☐ Social Audit (high-yield gap)

HIGH**Advanced · UPSC Traps**GS-II Indian
Polity**INTRO & ORIGIN**

municipalities).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- three levels** are directly elected, but this does not make every chairperson/represented member directly elected.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: 73rd Amendment came into force in 1992

CORRECT: passed 1992, in force 24 April 1993.

WRONG: Eleventh Schedule has 29 items for municipalities

CORRECT: 29 for panchayats (Twelfth Schedule = 18 for

WRONG: All 3 tiers are compulsory for every state

CORRECT: a state less than 20 lakh may skip the intermediate tier.

WRONG: Only village-level territorial seats are directly elected

CORRECT: territorial seats at **all

WRONG: Minimum candidate age is 25

CORRECT: 21 for panchayats.

WRONG: Women's reservation is 1/3 and fixed

CORRECT: "not less than 1/3"; many states have raised it to 50%.

WRONG: PESA extends Part IX to Sixth Schedule areas

CORRECT: Fifth Schedule areas.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Panchayati Raj — 73rd Amendment (Articles 243–243-O, Part IX) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → UPSC Traps

HIGH**Advanced • CA hooks****GS-II** Indian
Polity**NEWS TRIGGER**

□ □ □ **50% women's reservation** in PRIs adopted by ~21 states — grassroots women's empowerment (links to the Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam debate). □ □ □ **15th/16th Finance Commission grants** to local bodies (tied/untied) & the demand for greater fiscal

INTRO & ORIGIN

devolution ("3 Fs — funds, functions, functionaries").

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

• □ □ □ **PESA implementation gaps** & tribal Gram Sabha rights (land acquisition, mining, FRA linkage).

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Panchayati Raj — 73rd Amendment (Articles 243–243-O, Part IX) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → □ CA hooks

HIGH

Advanced · Mains angles

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Mains angles.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

"Panchayati Raj has achieved political decentralisation but not administrative & fiscal decentralisation." Examine (the 3 Fs). Women's reservation in PRIs — has it led to genuine empowerment or "sarpanch-pati" proxy rule? PESA & tribal self-governance: promise vs ground reality.

STUDY LINK

Panchayati Raj — 73rd Amendment (Articles 243–243-O, Part IX) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Mains angles

End of Register Notes — UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI